Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Volume 52, Number 4 | Sunnyvale, California | April 2009

Volunteer Appreciation Night

April 8, 7:00 pm
Lakewood Park Building
Located at the North end of Lakewood Park

President's Column

-Michael Majchrowicz

We will be having a celebrative meeting on April 8th to acknowledge the many volunteers that participate throughout the year. Thank you to all our volunteers for Dumpster Day, the LVNA Picnic, the Holiday Parade, our Villager walkers, coordinators, and board members.

I am excited to see all these activities continue. **Again, Dumpster Day will be held on June 27th** this year. Don't miss it! It's a day more exciting than Christmas... The only thing better than getting and giving is throwing things away.

On a more serious note, I know with the economy in its current condition and many adjustable mortgages coming due, that many people find themselves at risk of losing their homes in our neighborhood.

Here are some helpful websites that can direct you to people who can re-negotiate your loan or find other alternates:

Hope Now

www.hopenow.com

Internal Revenue Service

www.irs.gov Search for "mortgage debt relief bill" and then click on "home foreclosure debt cancellation."

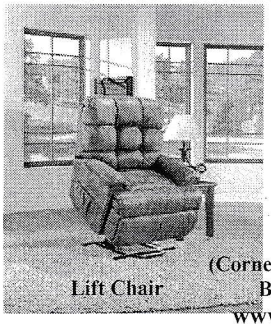
Fairwood and Lakewood Schools

If you would like more information about what is happening or how you can help out at our two elementary schools in the neighborhood, visit one of the following websites:

Fairwood School: www.sesd.org/schools/Fairwood

Lakewood School: www.sesd.org/schools/Lakewood

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Village Crime Statistics:

The Department of Public Safety has provided these crime statistics for Lakewood Village, February - March:

Assaults	6
Burglary:	6
Larceny:	2
Robbery:	1
Vehicle Stolen :	4
Vehicle Burglary:	6

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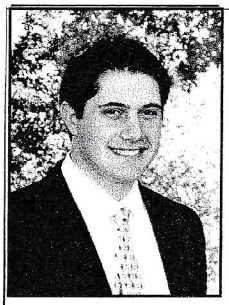


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olumbia Middle School Spring Musical

"Ease on Down the Road" and enjoy an evening with *The Wiz* – Columbia Middle School's Spring Musical.

The last performance will be at Bishop School on April 9 at 7 pm. Advanced tickets are $4 for adults and $3 for students. Children under 3 are free. Tickets will be $6 at the door. For advanced ticket information contact Tiffany Heppe at Tiffany.Heppe@sesd.org or (408) 522-8247 X104.

Sensory Friendly Movies – AMC Mercado

One Saturday a month at 10:00am, AMC Mercado Theatres offer a movie experience for people on the **Autism Spectrum**. They turn on the lights and turn down the sound of the movie. You can bring your own snacks and enjoy a movie in a safe environment. Call **(408) 919-0285** for dates.

Fairwood School: Kindergarten Registration

Kindergarten registration has begun and will continue through June. Monday - Friday between the hours of 10am - 2pm .

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Sunday Services
9:30 a.m. Sunday School for all ages
11:00 a.m. Worship Service
Wednesday
7:00 p.m. Corporate Prayer Meeting

LAKEWOOD PONY BASEBALL

The Season Has Begun!

Baseball has begun! Come out and watch the games Monday thru Thursday starting at 5:15pm or Saturdays throughout the day or the Saturday night game under the lights. There are still a few spots left for those who wish to register. $90.00 for Shetland (t-ball) and $110.00 for all other divisions.
For more info call 408-230-9388.
email: lakewoodponybaseball@yahoo.com.

Recent Burglaries

Unfortunately, we've had a handful of recent residential burglaries. Suspects have been entering yards (during the day) through unlocked side gates and forcing rear doors open. Please remember to lock your gates (Yes! You can!). Simply give PG&E a call and let them know you'll be locking your gate. Please dial 911 if you observe anything suspicious! Share this information with your neighbors.
Officer Benjamin Holt

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CITY OF SUNNYVALE

HOME IMPROVEMENT LOANS AND GRANTS

The high cost of housing and the repairs needed to maintain your home can be daunting. To help you maintain and enhance the livability of your home, the City of Sunnyvale offers several programs through the City's home improvement program to fund needed electrical, roofing, plumbing or heating repairs; painting the exterior of your home; retrofitting your home for handicapped accessibility; making your home more energy efficient; or making emergency repairs that pose a health and safety risk.

The City of Sunnyvale home improvement programs are funded with restricted federal funds to help low-income households at or below 80 percent of Area Median Income to maintain their homes. The City of Sunnyvale's housing rehabilitation program offers several home improvement programs; including single-family rehabilitation loans program, paint loans and grants programs, energy efficiency loan program, and home access grants program.

Household Incomes for These Programs Must Be Less Than:

$59,400 for 1 person	$76,400 for 3 people
$67,900 for 2 people	$84,900 for 4 people

SINGLE FAMILY REHABILITATION LOANS

The Housing Rehabilitation Program offers low-interest deferred loans of up to $60,000 for single-family homes to address code violations, deferred maintenance, general improvements and livability of the structure. The loans can be used for the following necessary repairs: electrical, roofing, weatherization, kitchen remodel, plumbing, heating, bath remodel, structural reinforcement and all health and safety-related issues.

PAINT LOANS AND GRANTS

The City of Sunnyvale offers a paint grant or paint loan that can be used to paint the exterior of your home. The paint grant is a grant up to $1,000 to reimburse you for paint materials and lead testing. The paint loan is a low-interest deferred loan, for an amount up to $4,000 to paint the exterior of your home.

ENERGY EFFICIENCY LOAN

The Energy Efficiency Program provides low-interest deferred loans of up to $25,000 to increase the energy efficiency of residences. The program funds repairs to replace inefficient and aging appliances, heating systems, windows, increase insulation and other types of weatherization improvements.

HOME ACCESS GRANTS FOR DISABLED RESIDENTS

The Home Access Grant Program provides grants up to $6,500 to disabled or frail elderly homeowners or tenants to retrofit their home by eliminating physical barriers which inhibit the use of the home. Typical projects funded through the program range from bathroom modifications which include: grab bars, bath benches, and hand-held shower heads; to modular ramps, door widening and the installation of hydraulic lifts (with property owner consent of rental properties).

For more information on any of these programs, contact Richard Gutierrez at (408) 730-7459, or e-mail *rgutierrez@ci.sunnyvale.ca.us*, or visit *www.sunnyvale.ca.gov/housing.*

Taxes, Taxes, Taxes

April 15 is just around the corner, and you are now panicking because you have not filed your 2008 taxes yet… You are not alone, but the deadline to file is looming on the horizon. Here is some information on the 2008 Tax Code that may help you realize a refund instead of owing:

Standard Deduction –This deduction depends on your filing status, age, and whether you are blind. If you are married filing separately, you must both either take the standard deduction or itemize, but not mix and match.

IRA contributions, for tax years 2008 and 2009 are limited to **$5,000 if aged 49 or under, and $6,000 aged 50 or over. You can reduce taxable income by contributing money to a traditional** individual retirement account (IRA) and contribution must be made by 4/15/09 for '08 return. Total contributions cannot exceed earned income or the amounts stated above, and you must be under age 70 ½ at the end of '08.

An additional standard deduction for **property tax** of $500 for single and $1,000 for joint filers.

The **Housing Assistance Tax Act of 2008** allows homeowners to claim an additional standard deduction for property tax if the taxpayer does not itemize.

Mortgage Insurance Premiums may be deductible – Many homeowners must pay mortgage insurance premiums if they don't have a sufficient down payment. Mortgage insurance premiums are now deductible as part of the mortgage interest deduction. Mortgage insurance provided by Veterans Administration, the Federal Housing Administration, the Rural Housing Administration, and private mortgage insurance companies all qualify for the deduction.

Tax relief for Foreclosures and Mortgage Restructuring may qualify for tax relief – Normally debts canceled by a lender are considered taxable income, but a change in the tax law makes mortgage on a main home exempt from the tax on canceled debts.

Hopefully this information helps in some way to reduce your AGI, and increase your tax deductibles and credits. If not, please call or email me. I would love to help you resolve your tax problems and set up a tax plan for 2009. My email is chung-tax@yahoo.com, and my number is 408-507-1498

By Grace Chung, CRTP of Chung Tax Service

(408) 733-9218
(408) 398-1328 Cell

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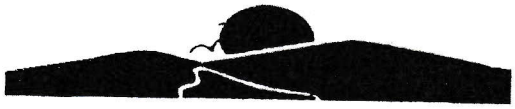
Great American Litter Pick-up Event

Saturday, April 25, from 9 a.m. – Noon.
The goal is to clean up litter in neighborhoods and next to roadways around Fair Oaks Park, Lakewood Park, and the Columbia Neighborhood Center. Gloves, pick-up sticks, safety vests, and bags will be available for our volunteers. Also, in cooperation with Sunnyvale Parks' staff, some park maintenance and beautification activities needing volunteer help will occur at these locations on this date. To sign-up for a location or ask any questions regarding the Great American Litter Pick-up event, call Environmental Outreach at (408) 730-7717 or e-mail: *WPCP@ci.sunnyvale.ca.us*.

Sunnyvale Garage Sale Day

Saturday, April 25. Each year, the City designates a city-wide garage sale day for the purpose of promoting re-use of household goods among residents and neighbors. Residents who choose to take part in Garage Sale Day can set-up individual sales or team together with neighbors, blocks or neighborhood associations. Garage sales are a great way to meet your neighbors or raise funds for a community activity. And the best part, it keeps local landfills free of items that still have an useful purpose. To get more info or register for this annual event, please visit *www.sunnyvalerecycles.org*.

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AARP Free Tax Service

The AARP is doing taxes (non-complicated ones) free in the Sunnyvale Community Center for anyone.

For information, or to set up an appointment, call the AARP coordinator at (408) 735-0653. Taxes will be done on Thursdays & Fridays.

Full Circle Farm Reopens

Full Circle Farm, an 11-acre organic farm and educational program located next to Peterson Middle School in Sunnyvale at 1055 Dunford Way is open on Wednesdays and Fridays from 3 to 7 p.m.

An assortment of freshly picked winter vegetables including green garlic, onions, broccolini, chard and cauliflower, will be available. Fresh honey from the farm's beehives and local beekeeper Mark Patterson will also be on sale.

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Delivery (Lakewood)	Wendy Stanley	walkers@lvna.net	745-1331
http://www.lvna.net/Miscellany/Contact/contact.html			

Internet Links

LVNA Web Site	http://www.lvna.net
Lakewood Village E-mail List	http://www.topica.com/lists/lakewoodvillage
City of Sunnyvale	http://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov
Sunnyvale Library	http://www.sunnyvalelibrary.org
Sunnyvale Free Recycling	http://groups.yahoo.com/group/sunnyvalefree

Upcoming Events

What	Where	When
Street Sweeping	Your street - move your cars!	4/7 Fairwood 4/14 Lakewood 5/5 Fairwood 5/12 Lakewood
Compost Workshop	Sunnyvale Community Center Arboretum	4/18 10 am. - noon
Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off	Carl Road, near the SMaRT Station	4/18 8 am - 1 pm
LVNA *Villager* Editorial Deadline	Contact editor@lvna.net	5/01
LVNA Meeting	Lakewood Park Bldg	4/08

Important Phone Numbers

Public Safety - Emergency	**911**
Public Safety - Non-emergency	**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal repair, dead animals	Dispatch 730-7180
Noise complaints, homeless complaints, commercial vehicles on residential streets	Desk Officer 730-7110
Illegal storage or buildings, decrepit fences or buildings, weed problems, illegal home businesses, rental housing complaints, commercial vehicles on private property	Neighborhood Preservation 730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
City Streets, sidewalks, trees, streetlights, street sweeping	Public Works 730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline	730-7680
Shopping Cart Pickup	725-1010
Neighborhood Liaison	730-7472
http://www.lvna.net/Resources/Phones/phones.html	



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